

The Copilot Prompt Taxonomy: Quick Reference Guide

The Master Formula (Your Foundation)

"Act as a **[Role]**. **[Anchor Verb]** this **[Source]** for the **[Audience]** in a suitable **[Tone]** and place it into a **[Format]** to ensure I am able to meet the **[Goal]** subject to the following **[Constraints]**."

LAYER 1: The Insight Layer

Focus: Critical Analysis & Quality Assurance. Use this to find what is hidden, missing, or logically flawed. **Key Objective:** "Is this information accurate, complete, and unbiased?"

App	Anchor Verb	Example Template Prompt
Word	Audit	"Act as a Legal Specialist . Audit this contract for Risk Managers in a formal tone to identify liability gaps ."
Word	Verify	"Act as a Fact-Checker . Verify this proposal for the Board to ensure claims match the evidence ."
Excel	Verify	"Act as a Financial Controller . Verify this sheet for Auditors to find formula errors or outliers ."
Excel	Gauge	"Act as a Data Analyst . Gauge these sales figures to determine if growth is sustainable ."
PPT	Challenge	"Act as a Skeptical Investor . Challenge these slides to find weak ROI arguments ."
PPT	Audit	"Act as a Brand Manager . Audit these slides to ensure brand compliance and consistency ."
Outlook	Gauge	"Act as a HR Lead . Gauge this thread to find hidden sentiment or frustration ."
Outlook	Uncover	"Act as a Negotiator . Uncover the sender's true priority in this complex request."
Teams	Uncover	"Act as a Project Strategist . Uncover the unspoken assumptions made in this chat history."
Teams	Verify	"Act as a Scribe . Verify if all verbal agreements from the meeting were captured in the chat."

LAYER 2: The Operational Layer

Focus: Efficiency, Workflow, and Execution. Use this to turn messy data into organized labour. **Key Objective:** "What are the specific actions, and who owns them?"

App	Anchor Verb	Example Template Prompt
Word	Sequence	"Act as an Ops Lead . Sequence these notes into a step-by-step implementation roadmap ."
Word	Mitigate	"Act as a Project Manager . Mitigate the issues in this doc by suggesting a contingency for each ."
Excel	Extract	"Act as a Sales Lead . Extract all underperforming accounts into a prioritized follow-up list."
Excel	Sequence	"Act as a Logistics Planner . Sequence these delivery dates into an optimized route table ."
PPT	Mitigate	"Act as a Crisis Manager . Mitigate the risks shown in this deck by adding a ' Next Steps ' slide."
PPT	Extract	"Act as a Researcher . Extract all key statistics from this deck into a one-page handout."
Outlook	Synthesize	"Act as a Chief of Staff . Synthesize this thread into a 3-bullet briefing for my Director."
Outlook	Extract	"Act as an Executive Assistant . Extract all dates and deadlines and format them as a calendar list."
Teams	Delegate	"Act as a Team Lead . Delegate the tasks from this meeting to the appropriate owners ."
Teams	Sequence	"Act as a Facilitator . Sequence this chat into an agenda for our follow-up meeting."

LAYER 3: The Transformation Layer

Focus: Adaptation, Delivery, and Presentation. Use this to change the "shape" or "voice" of your content. **Key Objective:** "How do I make this message land perfectly for this specific audience?"

App	Anchor Verb	Example Template Prompt
Word	Adapt	"Act as a Trainer . Adapt this technical report into an easy-to-read FAQ for new hires."
Word	Refine	"Act as an Editor . Refine this draft to be more persuasive while cutting the length by 30%."
Excel	Visualize	"Act as a Designer . Visualize this data by suggesting the top 3 chart types for a Board deck."
Excel	Adapt	"Act as a Storyteller . Adapt these raw numbers into a narrative summary of our yearly success."
PPT	Storyboard	"Act as a Creative Director . Storyboard 8 slides based on the core themes of this Word doc."
PPT	Refine	"Act as a Speaker Coach . Refine the bullet points on these slides to be punchy and memorable ."
Outlook	Refine	"Act as a Diplomat . Refine my draft email to be softer but still firm on the deadline."
Outlook	Distill	"Act as a Journalist . Distill this 20-email thread into a single 'TL;DR' paragraph ."
Teams	Distill	"Act as a Social Media Lead . Distill this internal win into a LinkedIn post for our followers."
Teams	Adapt	"Act as a News Anchor . Adapt this chat transcript into a 30-second 'Weekly Update' script ."

LAYER 4: The Expansion Layer

Focus: Strategy, Forecasting, and Innovation. Use this to look beyond the page and predict the future. **Key Objective:** "What does this mean for our long-term strategy and what is next?"

App	Anchor Verb	Example Template Prompt
Word	Scout	"Act as a Market Researcher . Scout this report for 3 emerging trends we haven't noticed."
Word	Reframe	"Act as a Strategist . Reframe the failures in this report as competitive advantages ."
Excel	Extrapolate	"Act as a Financial Planner . Extrapolate these figures to show where we will be in 12 months ."
Excel	Anticipate	"Act as a Business Analyst . Anticipate where the biggest budget leaks will occur based on this data."
PPT	Anticipate	"Act as a Sales Coach . Anticipate the top 5 objections a client will have after this presentation."
PPT	Scout	"Act as a Visionary . Scout this deck for one big 'Moonshot' idea we could pitch next."
Outlook	Connect	"Act as a Partnership Lead . Connect this email's request to our 2026 strategic goals ."
Outlook	Anticipate	"Act as a Crisis Comms Lead . Anticipate the recipient's reaction and draft a 'Plan B' reply."
Teams	Extrapolate	"Act as a Project Futurist . Extrapolate the final project outcome based on current chat delays."
Teams	Connect	"Act as a Culture Builder . Connect this team discussion to our core company values ."